FOOD REMEDY API

Competitive App Research: OneLabel [RE005]

Prepared For: Food Remedy API Team

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INTRODUCTION

OneLabel is a barcode/photo scanner for food and personal-care products that translates labels into a simple colour-coded score and detailed ingredient notes. It claims alerts for gluten, general allergies, vegan, and FODMAP preferences; rates foods on nutrition, additives, and organic status (with a Nutri-Score–based method); and rates cosmetics by ingredient risk with a 0–100 score. Strengths include clear scoring, ingredient drilldowns, and personalisation; gaps include inconsistent database size claims and accuracy variance between barcode vs photo scans.

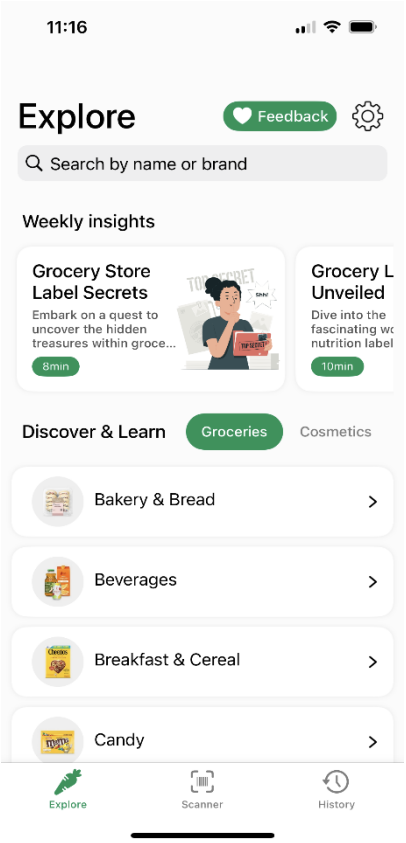
FEATURES AND FUNCTIONALITY

1. How OneLabel breaks down product ingredients

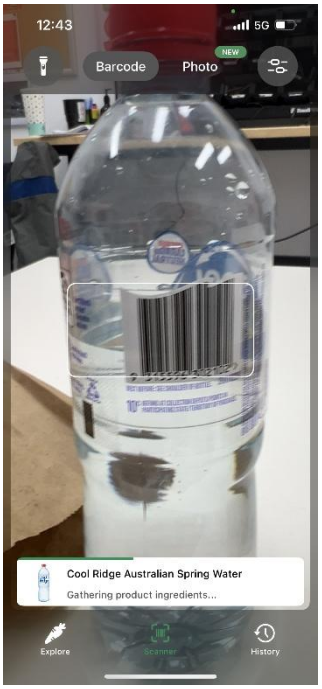
Food products: Uses three pillars: nutritional quality, presence of additives, and organic aspects. Nutrition is calculated via Nutri-Score (with their own tweaks to avoid "threshold effects"); additives are evaluated against sources such as EFSA and IARC; organic labels add a bonus. Output is presented on an easy green→red scale.

Cosmetics & personal care: Ingredients receive risk levels based on medical review; the app shows ingredient-level risks with cited sources and aggregates to a 0–100 product score (100 = safest).

What this means in practice: Users see an overall score, then can drill down to which ingredients or additive classes pulled the score down (e.g., colour additives, preservatives), and whether an organic label helped. (Method details and terminology from OneLabel's own "How it works".)



2. Scanning modes & accuracy



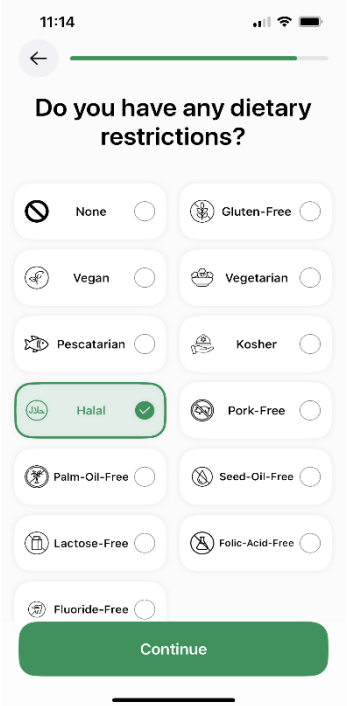
Two scan paths: Barcode (pulls a matched product record) and Photo (AI reads the label). The developer states barcode is "usually the most accurate", while photo OCR/AI can misread or mismatch in poor conditions; they say they're improving photo accuracy.

Speed: marketing claims "check ingredients in less than 1 second." Real-world reviews are mixed, with some users praising speed and others noting gaps when products aren't in the database.

Coverage (database size): claims vary across sources:

- App Store lists 3 million referenced products.
- Website marketing page claims **"500M+" items** (food, cosmetic, household). Treat this as a claim rather than a verified figure.

3. How warnings are triggered (allergens & preferences)

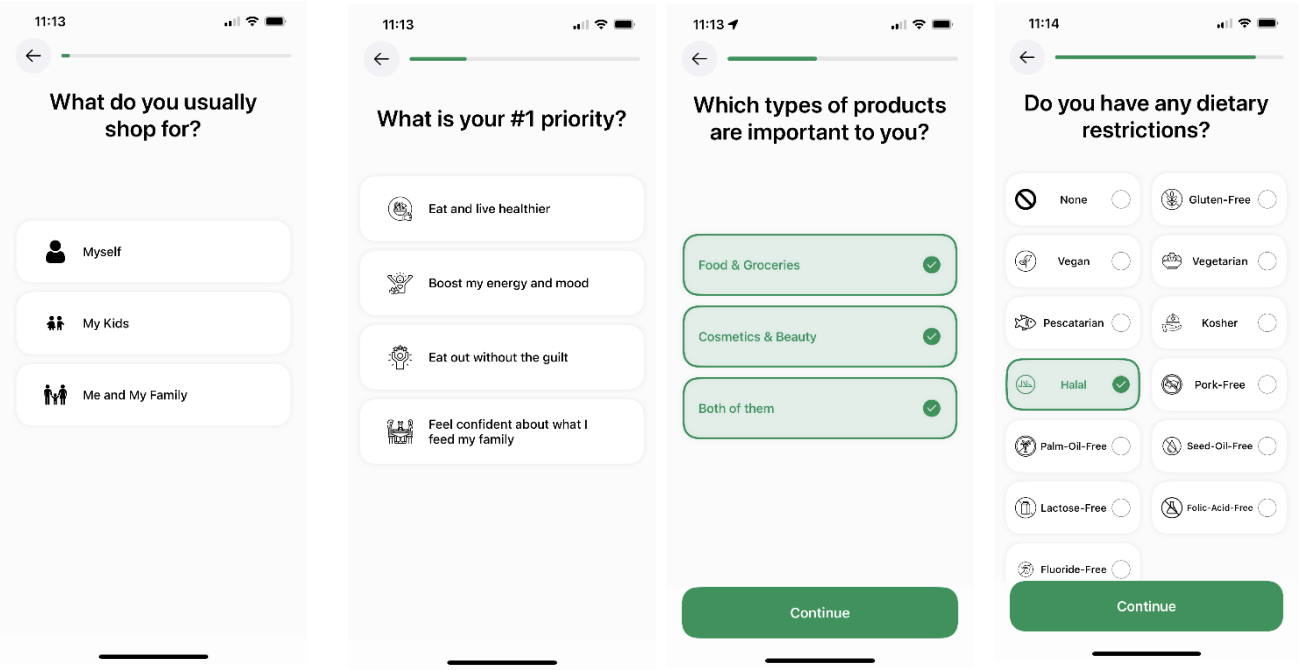


- During onboarding the app asks what matters to you (e.g., allergies/ingredients/environment). Developer responses say this personalises the scanner and results.
- The App Store description explicitly advertises alerts for Gluten, Allergy, Vegan, and FODMAP—i.e., if a scanned product contains an ingredient that conflicts with those preferences, the app flags it.

4. Strengths

a. **Clear model & transparency:** Three-pillar food model; risk-scored cosmetic ingredients with source citations. Easier to trust than black box "good/bad."
b. **Personalised warnings:** Onboarding preferences tailor what gets flagged for each user.
c. **Dual input (barcode + photo):** Useful fallback when a barcode match is missing.

One Replicable Feature for Food Remedy API

Personalised, rules-based alert badges at scan time.

- Ask 3–5 quick onboarding questions (e.g., *gluten*, *lactose*, *vegan*,). Then, on each product screen, show inline badges (e.g., “Contains gluten,” “Vegan-friendly,” etc) next to the ingredient list and overall score.